

BEAR WORKOUTS F26 - WELCOME TO SPRING 2026

YES WE ARE WORKING OUT ON DAY 1 !!!!

Caveat! When you receive “BEAR WORKOUTS S26” bCourse email notifications please log *directly* onto bCourses (click the link at bottom of the notification) so you have *full access* to the links, photos, and videos included in the Announcements. This document is your "mini syllabus" and includes everything you need to know about policies, passing the course, mandatory attendance, mandatory 7 day makeup deadlines and procedures, the “no excuses” mindset, equipment use/storage/cleaning, course updates, ”last call” courtesy reminders for permission codes, adds, drops, and grade changes, dropping from the waitlists, required DSP student-initiated communications, pre-existing conditions, evacuations and emergencies, procedures for online Zoom students, and what to expect on Day 1 and beyond. If you are unwilling to comply with any and all of said policies then instructional training is not for you. As a win-win alternative you may consider the RSF for drop-in classes with a recreational approach, zero roll call, and zero accountability.

Ciao a tutti! I hope your winter break was a blast! BEAR WORKOUTS S26 starts tomorrow January 20 for TT students, January 21 for MW students, and we roll through to the last day of class on April 29 (MW) and April 30 (TT).

For initially-enrolled students and late-enrollees, please be sure to read this Announcement in bCourses *before* you come to your first class so you are fully informed, prepared and ready for action. “Not knowing” is not an excuse for not knowing! And yes---we will be working out on the first day of class. Arrive **on time no later than 10 minutes after the hour** in appropriate fitness attire, athletic shoes (calisthenics only), long hair tied back for safety and visibility, and be ready for roll call and some serious "get back into shape" post-holiday training. Equipment is provided with disinfectant supplies available for clean-up after each workout. If you own your own exercise/yoga mat please bring it, and a reusable water bottle; water dispenser is next to the Hearst Service Center; water fountains located throughout the building.

Starting from scratch~

Waitlisters may be wondering why you weren't able to enroll when the course shows that seats were available. This is due to an allotment for incoming freshmen and for the course enrollment reaching an allotment quota for your specific class level. No fear!

1. **Waitlisters** - Please make a decision on *enrolling* in the course, otherwise manually *drop* yourself from the Waitlist ASAP to avoid subsequent administrative fees on your CARS account. If you do not drop and do not attend you will receive a failing grade at the end of the semester, i.e., F or NP. **IF YOU WANT TO ADD FROM THE WAITLIST PLEASE EMAIL ME tonimar@berkeley.edu IMMEDIATELY** and include your name, SID and the course (day/time will suffice).
2. **Crashers or Walk-ons** i.e, you are *not* on the Waitlist but want to enroll, **EMAIL ME IMMEDIATELY tonimar@berkeley.edu** with your SID and course (day/time). A Permission Code will be emailed to you.
3. How to use Permission code: <https://pe.berkeley.edu/faqs/adding-class-using-permission-code>
4. If you experience difficulties with enrollment send explanations and screenshots.

BEAR WORKOUTS F26 - WELCOME TO SPRING 2026

How to access Hearst Gymnasium during campus construction hours (7:00am-3:00pm)

There are 3 access doors to Hearst Gymnasium (1) East Entrance (near the parking lot construction site), (2) West Entrance, and (3) North Entrance (west end of the long row of windows).

Special access information for those attending the 7:00am classes (MW 7-8am Yoga Vinyasa and TT 7-8am Running & Core students): Access Hearst Gymnasium at the East Entrance from (1) Optometry Lane, (2) Bancroft Way, or (3) the pathway along the North Field from Social Sciences Building. The west and north entrances are locked and alarmed until 7:45am. Students in classes starting at 8am thereon may enter at any of the entrances.

Logistics

1. **Class locations:** Both gymnasiums 251 and 234 are located on the 2nd floor at the east end of the building. Use the east stairway to the 2nd floor: 251 is at the top of the stairs. For 234: From the top of the east stairs > walk outside the double doors > continue south across the open walkway and reenter through the R set of double doors > 234 will be to your R.
2. **Equipment logistics for 251 and 234:** After the first day of class you'll see that I've done my best to accommodate as many students as safely as possible for visibility, instruction and space to move. ERGO it is important that everyone collaborate with their classmates to be sure we set up mats and equipment in *uniform, organized rows and do not leave any large gaps of space between you and your classmates.*
3. **Storing personal belongings:** If you do not use a locker store your belongings at the 251 west end of the room and the 234 east end of the gym. Do not block any of the equipment storage cabinets. Absolutely no electronic devices, mobile devices, headsets, headphones, AirPods, etc. in the training area.
4. **251 and 234 Entry Doors:** Do not block any of the entry door areas with your exercise space and/or personal belongings as a precautionary measure for emergencies, evacuations, and paramedic entry including gurney space. Keep it clear!
5. **Micromobility vehicles:** Bicycles, scooters, skateboards, etc. must be parked outside of the building.
6. **Points perspective:** My preference for grading is *responsibility*, i.e., the student arrives on time, contacts instructor if running late or incurs an absence, participates throughout the entire duration of class time, does not leave early, cleans their equipment after use, and stores their equipment in a neat and organized manner. In terms of grading with points, consider all of the above earning 1.0 point. Half a point for arriving late. Zero points for missing class but earned with 1.0 if the absence is made up within 7 days.
7. **Be prompt and arrive early** to set up and organize your equipment, and be ready for Cal Time roll call at 10 minutes after the hour; classes are large so we *will be doing warmups during Roll Call to make efficient use of our limited instructional 35-40 minute workout.* If your preceding class is across the campus it is your responsibility to inform me of your ETA, otherwise you will be considered late (0.5 point) which will be reflected in your final grade. Training will cease at 10 minutes of the hour to clean/disinfect and store your equipment and arrive to your next class on time. Please mind “the big picture”: classes

BEAR WORKOUTS F26 - WELCOME TO SPRING 2026

are large and necessitate a reasonable margin of time for arrival and set-up, training time of approximately 30-40 minutes, and time for clean-up and equipment storage. This limited schedule also serendipitously demonstrates how effective a 30-minute workout can be---especially important to remember when you leave CAL and are working full time or multiple part-time jobs, commuting, graduate school, studying for state board exams, raising kids, caregiving for parents, etc.---you don't need an unrealistic hour or two to get a decent workout; that is an old exercise myth but a popular sales pitch for health and fitness clubs and studios). *Thirty minutes can get the job done* if you know what to do, do it correctly, perform it efficiently, and are consistent. Plus, it's a *realistic* positive lifestyle behavior that we will be reinforcing in class. Consistency counts!

8. **If you leave early:** 0.5 point deducted.
9. **If you arrive LATE:** Do NOT disrupt the class by wandering across the training area. Rather, politely enter *quietly*; don't let the door slam behind you, and walk the *periphery of the room*, find a place to set up. If you must leave early advise the instructor in advance, do not leave your equipment behind (room service not available), *quietly* clean/disinfect and store your equipment, and exit around the *periphery* of the room; do not walk across the training area. Courteous gym etiquette is practiced at all times. If you leave the room at any time it your responsibility to inform the instructor.
10. **Be prepared!** "If you fail to prepare, then be prepared to fail." Bring a reusable water bottle. Practice good hygiene and arrive dressed in appropriate fitness attire and functional intact shoes, long hair tied up and back to provide full visibility for safety reasons (bring your own tie or scrunchy), no movement-obstructive jewelry (to prevent jewelry-related injuries), no essential oils or fragrances that will interfere with your training. All electronic devices are to be OFF/silent and *off the training area*. Exception: First Responders or M.D.'s **on call:** inform the instructor and show credentials in advance.
11. **Preexisting Conditions and/or Performance-impairing medications:** Your skill set is objectively evaluated as part of your final grade and based on the principles of exercise science and biomechanics. If you have a preexisting condition or are prescribed a medication that may potentially impair or limit your ability to execute a movement, lose balance, etc. please advise the instructor so modifications or alternatives may be provided. Disclosures are confidential.
12. **Disabled Student Program** Accommodations are not in effect until (1) a Letter of Accommodation (LOA) is sent from your advisor and, per yDSP policy, (2) **you have initiated contact with the instructor about specific accommodations and considerations.** Your LOA states that *it is the responsibility of the student to contact the instructor*. For example, absences may be in your LOA but we'll need to discuss the number of absences and makeup deadlines in a memorandum of agreement and how this may affect your overall performance and risk of injury especially when the makeup deadline extension is an accommodation. Fitness, skill set and momentum start to decline within 7 days which is why it is important to understand the physiological risk of injury with any extension period for makeups. Accommodations may be made for home exercise if viable and during the period of absences.
13. **ONLINE STUDENTS!** All classes are conducted on Zoom. Please check your *course site* from the bCourses dashboard to access the meetings (classes). All meetings are recorded and stored in the cloud and available in the Zoom menu "Cloud Recordings."

BEAR WORKOUTS F26 - WELCOME TO SPRING 2026

[Everything you need to know about Zoom](#) is in the Files menu in the File Menu in (1) BEAR WORKOUTS S26 bCourses site and in (2) your individual course site. Be sure to read the file or you may get lost. You either attend class during the scheduled meetings (*synchronous attendance*) or attend within 7 days of the scheduled meeting (*asynchronous attendance*). **You receive credit for attendance either way.** If you attend *asynchronously* (1) upload a ≤ 2 minute takeaway video file to your Google Drive and inform me that the video file is available for viewing OR (2) simply attach the video file to your email, and be sure to (3) meet the 7-day asynchronous time period. **This is not a self-paced course.** If you attend synchronously you do not send a video because you attended during the scheduled meeting. Such is the convenience of online classes! You decide if/when you will attend class---scheduled or during your own time via the Cloud Recordings.

14. [Restrooms, lockers, showers](#) Please be aware of your surroundings and report any suspicious activity and/or loiterers. Have a buddy system for safety reasons. Do not leave valuables in the locker.
15. ["Women's Lockers/showers/restrooms"](#) - Located at the west end of the 1st Floor and around the corner from the Hearst Service Center (HSC). If you use a locker you must bring your own lock.
16. ["Men's Lockers/showers/restrooms"](#) - Located on 1st Floor at the east end of the hallway. If you use a locker bring your own lock.
17. ["Anybody/Everybody Restroom"](#) - Located on 1st Floor on north side of hallway near Men's Locker Room.
18. [Emergency Evacuation or Lockdown](#) - We will review the evacuation pathways from 251 and 234 in class. The group assembly location is the North Field, subject to change based on campus construction.
19. [Understanding Grading](#) Miss class you won't pass! But relax! This does not preclude the considerations for legitimate absences, nor jeopardize your ability to pass the course. Let's face it, life happens—interviews, conferences, didn't hear the 4th alarm clock, illnesses/injuries, religious observances, IA or club athletic events, emergencies, no babysitter, no transportation, etc. Simply adhere to the makeup policy (see below) and you'll be fine. **But it is important to understand the 100% attendance policy.** You are graded on (1) **attendance** and (2) **performance** using an *algorithm* designed to first develop *fitness parameters* (muscle strength, muscle endurance, cardiovascular endurance, flexibility, body awareness, balance; *athletic attributes* (speed, power, agility, reaction time, quickness, etc.) that are essential for the successful acquisition of the activity-specific *skill set* (consistency in alignment, form, execution) developed from Cal Time **30-minute twice-per-week practices** for **15 weeks** for a total of 15 hours. Added benefit: Our training not only reinforces success in attaining fitness goals—it reaffirms the behaviors for success in life: the only way to do well is to consistently show up and do the work. It's not rocket science.

20. [HOW DO I MAKE UP A CLASS?](#)

In-person students: (1) Attend a comparable in-person tonimar class *within 7 days* of your absence. Note: By the mid-term of the semester you will have established the fundamentals of training and may attend a different type of class to explore other fitness modalities. Schedule of classes: <https://pe.berkeley.edu/faculty/toni-mar> OR <https://www.coursicle.com/berkeley/>

BEAR WORKOUTS F26 - WELCOME TO SPRING 2026

[professors/Toni+Mar/](#); (2) Advise of the makeup class that you want to attend, arrive on time, and check in with me *before* class starts so your makeup can be recorded and participate for the duration of instruction; (3) [Additional makeup option](#): You may also attend the TT 10-11 Vinyasa class *in-person* in 234 Hearst where I conduct the online class; (4) You may complete makeups preemptively: You complete a makeup in advance of a planned or unexpected absence, Students often attend additional classes for the extra workouts and are credited as preemptive and “banked” makeups for the future.

[Online Zoom Vinyasa students](#): As mentioned in your Zoomer File, you participate in the Zoom meetings either synchronously or asynchronously. [Additional Option](#): You may also attend any of the in-person Vinyasa classes for your synchronous attendance (instead of attending the scheduled online meeting, and also for asynchronous attendance (instead of following the Cloud Recording) BUT you must advise accordingly to be sure you receive credit for attendance. You may also attend the in-person Vinyasa classes to complete preemptive makeups.

[Considerations for all students](#): Your final grade will reflect attendance, promptness, tardies, preparedness, partial participation in class, leaving class early, and missed 7-day deadlines. Remember that the RSF offers a variety of in-person and online *recreational* exercise classes as an option to our courses. **If you have chronic and excessive absences**: you should drop the course before the academic drop deadline. If there are extenuating circumstances (let's be real--- these kinds of situations may happen) and your makeup deadline exceeds the 7-day grace period it is your responsibility to contact the instructor to discuss a viable solution that aligns with the course policies and fiduciary obligations. Better to do this than not show up, not communicate, and end up plea bargaining before final grades are submitted, and receive an F or NP if you choose not to deal with it. Eliminate the stress. Let's talk!

[What can I expect to get out of this course?](#)

Professor ratings

<https://berkeley.uloop.com/professors/view.php/56459/Toni-Mar>,

<https://www.ratemyprofessors.com/professor/312615>

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/tonimar1>

Who is my teacher? Bear's Bench (ucberkeleyofficial) Select any link:

Instagram <https://www.instagram.com/p/DDh1xGiyIiK/>

LinkedIn https://www.linkedin.com/posts/uc-berkeley_from-being-the-yoga-coach-for-the-football-activity-7273486552050114560-f_MC/?utm_source=share&utm_medium=member_desktop&utm_source=Berkeleyan&utm_campaign=893d7e4823-berkeleyan_COPY_01&utm_medium=email&utm_term=0_99ee3800d7-893d7e4823-388765697

BEAR WORKOUTS F26 - WELCOME TO SPRING 2026

Facebook <https://www.facebook.com/reel/601779349026408>

Interested in yoga?

2019 Spring Dance Showcase - Yoga <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xcU9zwElfVE>

Namaste Toni Mar <https://www.facebook.com/groups/2263413103/>

Schedule of classes & contact information tonimar@berkeley.edu

UC Phys Ed: <https://pe.berkeley.edu/faculty/toni-mar>

Coursicle: <https://www.coursicle.com/berkeley/professors/Toni+Mar/>

Office Hours: Monday through Thursday in-person/225 Hearst or online/Zoom by appt. only

For ALL students: bCourses Dashboard “[BEAR WORKOUTS S26](#)”

CALENDAR

Tue Jan. 20	Day 1 for TT sections
Wed. Jan 21	Day 1 for MW sections
Wed. Feb. 11	Deadline for Adds/Drops without a fee; verify date with your academic advisor
Mon. Feb. 16	HOLIDAY Veteran’s Day
Feb. 23-Mar. 17	Midterm Deficient Grading period
Sat. Mar. 7	Daylight Savings Time - Set your clock forward 1 hour before you go to bed
Sun. Mar.8	Daylight Savings Time in effect
Mar. 23-26	Spring Break
Wed. April. 29	Last day of class for MW sections
Thur. April 30	Last day of class for TT in-person sections and final meeting for online students
Tue. May 5	Final day for online students to submit asynchronous videos 11:59pm PST
Tue. May 5	End of Semester (EOS) Party at 4:15pm! Passione Pizza, 2324A 5th St. Everyone is invited! \$8 gratuity per person/RSVP for the restaurant staff Venmo TBA

<https://www.passioneemporio.com/>

BEAR WORKOUTS F26 - WELCOME TO SPRING 2026

Interested in core, conditioning, and core & yoga?

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Show up, do the work, and get results!



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Interested in Mindfulness & Stress Management?



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BEAR WORKOUTS F26 - WELCOME TO SPRING 2026

And don't forget to **congratulate yourself** for making the decision to reserve 2 days/week (or more) in your busy academic schedule for YOU and your health, wellness, and mental health by signing up for your Phys Ed class! You have made a commitment to get fit and maintain sanity amid the academic rigors of Cal. You are taking charge in balancing out your life. Exercise, proper nutrition, rest/recovery, and a positive mental attitude have a positive effect on mental health. So do remember to make time to chill out! Showing up for 15 weeks establishes a positive lifestyle behavior to take with you when you leave Cal.



BEAR WORKOUTS F26 - WELCOME TO SPRING 2026